

Career Design Survey Methods Note

Survey design, Qualtrics workflow, and internal consulting process

Purpose

This methods note summarizes the public-facing research workflow behind the Career Design survey and internship engagement project. It is intended for portfolio review and does not include raw survey responses.

Research Design

- Literature review on internship engagement, career readiness, rural student career development, and student use of campus career services.
- Qualtrics survey instrument developed to capture awareness, resource use, barriers, internship preferences, confidence, and desired assistance.
- Mixed-question design using demographic items, multiple-choice questions, Likert-style response options, and open-ended prompts.
- Survey distribution through campus channels and student organizations, including Honors communications, student networks, and business/student groups.

Survey Scope

- Final survey sample: 436 respondents.
- Demographic questions included class standing, first-generation status, traditional/nontraditional student status, employment status, and college or program affiliation.
- Substantive questions covered awareness of the Center, familiarity with services, prior service use, barriers to internship participation, internship preferences, and types of support students wanted most.

Analysis Workflow

- Cleaned and summarized quantitative response frequencies from Qualtrics output.
- Identified high-level themes from open-ended student responses.
- Compared USD survey results with literature review themes related to career-services awareness, paid internship preferences, rural student barriers, and mentorship.
- Translated patterns into recommendations for an internal campus client.

Privacy and Publication Note

Raw survey responses are not included in this public portfolio package. The artifacts use summary-level findings, representative themes, and screenshots/graphics that do not disclose individual student responses.